HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Personal Protective Equipment

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers personal protective equipment: what the work party wears - hard hats, safety boots and high-visibility clothing, gloves and goggles, face shields and hearing protection, flame-retardant and arc-rated clothing, chemical protective clothing and respiratory protective equipment. It appears in method statements and task risk assessments for every permit type.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- hard hats, safety boots and high-visibility vests worn on the job
- welding visors, gauntlets and flame-retardant overalls for hot work
- chemical-resistant gloves, goggles and coveralls when equipment is opened
- insulated gloves, an arc flash face shield and arc-rated clothing for switching
- respiratory protective equipment, face-fit tested for each wearer

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the permit type, the work activity and the hazards the request names.
2 Read each sentence of this kind for what is worn and by whom.
3 Check the equipment suits the job: flame-retardant for hot work, arc-rated for switching.
4 Note equipment the job needs that no sentence names.
5 Check respiratory protective equipment is face-fit tested for each wearer.

4. Requirements it bears on

Personal protective equipment bears on no requirement of any permit standard. It is the last line of protection: the requirements are met by the controls the request records, never by what the work party wears.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

A statement about protective equipment cannot disagree with the request, which records no answer about it; the reviewer notes equipment that does not suit the job for the Area Authority.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority for the protective equipment the work party will wear for each task, and for respiratory protective equipment the face-fit tests.

7. Telling it apart

What the work party wears is personal protective equipment; what gets them to the work position and stops them falling - a harness clipped to an anchor, edge protection - is access, which the Access guide covers. "Face shields are worn when grinding" is protective equipment; "harnesses are clipped to an anchor above the work" is access.